

LIGHT ENCOUNTER TABERNACLE WORLDWIDE

Site Operations Manual

The complete guide to running the LETW digital ecosystem

Public website · Admin dashboard · Members' area
Giving · Sermons & Live · Ministries · Marriage Prep
Content management · People · System & security

Prepared for church administrators and ministry leads

Reflects the live feature set of letw.org

Table of Contents

Table of Contents

2

1. Introduction & How to Use This Manual

4

2. Platform Overview

5

3. Getting Started — Signing In & the Dashboard

6

4. The Public Website

7

4.1 Primary navigation

7

4.2 Ministries & people

7

4.3 Education

7

4.4 Spiritual life

7

4.5 Care, life & community

8

4.6 Media, live & other

8

5. Admin — Everyday Operations

9

6. Admin — Content & Media

10

7. Admin — Worship, Sermons & Live

11

8. Admin — Giving

12

9. Admin — Ministries & Discipleship

13

9.1 Ministries group

13

9.2 Learning tracks

13

9.3 Member Journey group

13

10. Admin — Prayer, Evangelism & Outreach

14

11. Admin — Site Content & Page Copy

15

12. Admin — People, Governance & Communications

16

13. Admin — System, AI & Global Tools

17

14. Key Workflows (Step by Step)

18

14.1 Going live for a service

18

14.2 The Sunday-to-sermon workflow

18

14.3 Receiving and reconciling giving

18

14.4 Running Marriage Prep

18

14.5 Video calls in Marriage Prep (Jitsi)

19

14.6 Bookings, events and life events

19

14.7 Corporate fasting & prayer seasons

19

15. Understanding the Content System	20
16. Security, Publishing & Hosting	21
17. Troubleshooting	22

1. Introduction & How to Use This Manual

This manual describes how to operate the Light Encounter Tabernacle Worldwide (LETW) website end to end. The platform is a complete church digital ecosystem: a public-facing website for visitors and members, a members' area, and a large administrative dashboard where staff manage every piece of content and every ministry.

It is written for **non-technical church administrators and ministry leads**. You do not need to write code to run anything in this manual — almost every word, image, price, and setting on the public site is editable from the admin dashboard.

How the manual is organised

- **Section 2** — the big picture: the two halves of the platform and how they connect.
- **Section 3** — signing in and the admin dashboard layout.
- **Section 4** — the public website, page by page.
- **Sections 5–13** — the admin dashboard, grouped exactly as it appears in the sidebar.
- **Section 14** — deep-dive workflows you will use weekly (Sunday service, giving, marriage prep, etc.).
- **Section 15** — the content-management pattern that powers 'edit anything'.
- **Sections 16–17** — security, publishing/deployment, and troubleshooting.

Note: Throughout, admin pages are referenced by the path you see in the browser, e.g. */admin/sermons*. The public site lives at **letw.org**; the admin dashboard at **letw.org/admin**.

2. Platform Overview

The platform has two connected halves plus a members' area:

Public website (letw.org)	What visitors and members see: home, about, services, events, sermons, giving, ministries, education, prayer, and dozens more pages.
Admin dashboard (/admin)	Staff-only control centre. Every public page's content is edited here, plus people, giving, live streaming, ministries, communications and system tools.
Members' area	Signed-in members get a personal dashboard, messaging, prayer, growth tools, giving history and ministry participation.

How content flows

Nearly every visible element on the public site is stored in the database and edited from the admin. When you save a change in the admin, the public page reads the new content the next time it loads. If a content record is ever incomplete, the public page falls back to a sensible built-in default, so the site can never appear blank.

The technology, in one line

A Next.js website (hosted on Vercel) talks to a FastAPI application and PostgreSQL database (hosted on Render). You never touch these directly to run the church — they are named here only so you know who hosts what if you ever call technical support.

3. Getting Started — Signing In & the Dashboard

Signing in

- 1 Go to **letw.org/auth** (or click Sign in from the site) and log in with your staff account.
- 2 Administrators are taken to the dashboard at **letw.org/admin**. If you land on the public site, add **/admin** to the address.
- 3 If you don't have access, ask an existing administrator to create your account and grant the right role (see Section 12, Users & Governance).

The admin layout

- **Left sidebar** — every admin area, grouped by theme (some items expand into sub-menus).
- **Main panel** — the page you're working on.
- **Save buttons** — most editors have a Save button at the top and a sticky Save bar at the bottom; either works.
- **Status messages** — a green banner confirms a save; a red banner explains any error.

Note: A change is only live after you click **Save**. Many pages then say 'Refresh the public page to see the change.' Public pages may also take a few seconds to reflect edits because of caching.

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

For security, administrators should enable 2FA at **/admin/2fa**. Once enabled, you'll enter a code from your authenticator app each time you sign in.

4. The Public Website

These are the pages your congregation and visitors use. The main navigation bar carries the headline items; many more pages are reachable from menus, buttons and the footer.

4.1 Primary navigation

Home (/)	The landing page: hero video/banner, live-service banner when you're streaming, and highlights.
About (/about)	Who the church is, plus the cinematic Statement of Faith.
Services (/services)	Service times and what to expect.
Events (/events)	Upcoming events with details, photos and (where enabled) RSVP.
Sermons (/sermons)	The sermon library with video/audio, notes and podcast feed; integrates the live service when you're on air.
Impact (/impact)	Kingdom outcomes and testimonies of what God is doing.
Give (/giving)	The giving page — card, bank transfer, international and PayPal, with one-time and monthly options.

4.2 Ministries & people

Youth Ministry (/youth)	Youth programmes, events and sign-ups.
Children's Ministry (/children)	Family hub and secure children's check-in/out.
Men's Ministry (/men)	Men's ministry content and gatherings.
Women's Ministry (/women)	Women's ministry content and gatherings.
Leadership (/leadership)	The leadership team and training pathway.
Ministries (/ministries)	All custom ministries and how to get involved.
Volunteer (/volunteer)	Serve teams and the volunteer sign-up form.

4.3 Education

Overview (/education)	The education arm at a glance.
Primary / Secondary / University	Each school's dedicated page under /education/...
Theology School (/theology-school)	Ministerial and theological training.
Skill Development (/skill-development)	Practical skills courses.
Career Guidance (/career-guidance)	Career modules and coaching sessions.

4.4 Spiritual life

Prayer (/prayer) & Prayer Request (/prayer-request)	Prayer wall, schedules and requests; a live prayer centre connects requests to intercessors.
Bible Reading (/bible-reading) & Bible Study (/bible-study)	Reading plans, daily readings, study groups and resources.
Fasting (/fasting) & Lent (/lent)	Corporate fasts with daily prayer prompts and a shared rhythm.
Grow (/grow) & Pathway (/pathway)	The discipleship pathway and spiritual-growth engine (memory verses, habits).

Discipleship (/discipleship)	Structured discipleship journeys.
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4.5 Care, life & community

Counselling (/counselling)	Request confidential counselling appointments.
Life Events (/life-events)	Request weddings, baptisms, child dedications and memorials.
Marriage Prep (/marriage-prep)	The guided marriage-preparation course and enrolment (see Section 14.4).
Groups (/groups)	Small groups directory and joining.
Family (/family)	Family ministry hub.
Charity (/charity) & Missions (/missions)	Outreach, charity work and the missionary network.
Evangelism (/evangelism)	Evangelism campaigns and sign-ups.

4.6 Media, live & other

Live (/live)	The live service page — video, live chat and worship co-experience.
Blog (/blog) & RSS (/rss.xml)	The pastor's blog and its feed.
Voice (/voice)	Smart-speaker / voice-assistant information.
Tour (/tour)	The 3D virtual church tour.
Sanctuary (/sanctuary)	Book the wedding hall, chapel and rooms.
Testimony (/testimony) & Outcomes (/outcomes)	Testimonies and kingdom-outcome highlights.
Newsletter (/newsletter)	Subscribe to church email updates.
Contact / Join (/contact, /join)	Get in touch and become a member.
Apps (/apps)	The 'Church Apps' hub linking every digital tool.
Privacy & Terms (/privacy, /terms)	Legal pages.

Note: The exact set of menus is itself editable — see **Site Chrome** (/admin/site-content) in Section 11 to add, rename or reorder navigation items and dropdowns.

5. Admin — Everyday Operations

These top-of-sidebar items are the ones most staff touch daily or weekly.

Dashboard (/admin)	Your home screen — key numbers and shortcuts across the whole platform.
Live Stream (/admin/live-stream)	Start/stop the live service and set the stream URL. Turning it on shows the live banner across the public site (see 14.1).
Pending Approvals (/admin/approvals)	A single queue of items awaiting your yes/no — approve or reject here.
Service Requests (/admin/service-requests)	Incoming requests from members (forms across the site) to action.
Volunteers (/admin/volunteers)	People who signed up to serve; review and assign them.
Announcements (/admin/announcements)	Post site-wide announcements shown to visitors and members.
Newsletter (/admin/newsletter)	Manage subscribers and send email newsletters.
Sermons (/admin/sermons)	Add and edit sermons — video/audio, notes, series, documents (see 14.2).
Events (/admin/events)	Create and manage events, dates, details and photos.
Users (/admin/users)	All member and staff accounts; roles and country filters (see Section 12).
Nominations (/admin/nominations)	Leadership nominations to review.

6. Admin — Content & Media

Daily Verse (/admin/daily-verse)	Set the daily scripture shown across the site.
Pastor's Blog (/admin/blog)	Write, edit and publish blog posts (feeds the public /blog and its RSS).
Social Auto-Poster (/admin/social-posts)	Queue and auto-publish posts to your social channels.
SEO Meta (/admin/seo-meta)	Page titles and descriptions that appear in Google and social previews.
Statement of Faith (/admin/statement-of-faith)	Edit the cinematic statement-of-faith content on /about.
Testimony Page (/admin/testimony-page)	Curate testimonies; kingdom outcomes can be surfaced here.
Homepage Hero Video (/admin/hero-video)	Upload/replace the video or image that headlines the home page.
Downloads (/admin/downloads)	Upload files (sermons, e-books, bulletins, music) or link external ones for the public /download page.

Downloads — how it works

- Each item is either a hosted **file** (stored in the database, up to 25 MB) or an external **URL**.
- Give it a title, description and category (Sermon, E-book, Bulletin, Music, Video, Article, Other).
- Publish to make it visible; unpublish to hide without deleting.

7. Admin — Worship, Sermons & Live

Live Stream (/admin/live-stream)	The on/off switch and URL for the public live page and banner.
Sunday Automation (/admin/sunday-automation)	After a service, turn the recording into transcript, notes, an email, a blog draft, social posts and chapters — then edit and publish (see 14.2).
Caption Operator (/admin/live-captions)	Provide live captions/translation during services for online viewers.
Online Campus (/admin/online-campus)	Manage online-service listings, cover images, social links and their linked sermon/event.
Sermons (/admin/sermons)	The sermon library — see the Sunday workflow in 14.2.

8. Admin — Giving

Giving Page Content (/admin/giving-content)	Every word and account number on the public /giving page — hero text, tab labels, bank details, PayPal copy.
Payment Providers (/admin/payments)	Register and configure payment gateways. Supported: Paystack, Flutterwave, Stripe, PayPal, plus manual (bank instructions) and custom.
Donations Log (/admin/donations)	Every gift with donor, amount, fund, status and — for recurring gifts — the cadence.

Setting up a provider

- 1 Open /admin/payments and add a provider by its type (slug), e.g. 'paystack' or 'stripe'.
- 2 Enter its keys from that provider's own dashboard (public key, secret key, and webhook secret where applicable).
- 3 Set the currency and mark it active. Use 'test' mode to trial, 'live' mode for real gifts.
- 4 For bank transfer, use the 'manual' type and paste your bank instructions; for anything bespoke, use 'custom'.

Recurring (monthly) giving

- On /giving, donors can choose **Monthly** instead of a one-time gift — but only when the selected provider supports scheduled billing (**Stripe** or **Paystack**).
- Stripe uses a subscription; Paystack creates a plan automatically. The gift's cadence is recorded in the Donations Log.
- Donors self-manage (update card, pause, cancel) via the **'Manage or cancel a monthly gift'** link on /giving, which opens Stripe's Customer Portal.
- Providers that can't do recurring simply don't show the Monthly option.

Note: Recurring only appears once a Stripe and/or Paystack provider is configured with valid keys. To enable Stripe's self-service management, turn on the Customer Portal once in your Stripe dashboard.

9. Admin — Ministries & Discipleship

9.1 Ministries group

Custom Ministries (/admin/ministries)	Create and edit any ministry and its public page.
Volunteer Departments (/admin/volunteer-departments)	Define serve teams/departments and their coordinators.
Youth (/admin/youth, /admin/youth/programs)	Youth overview and programme management; coordinators use /youth/coordinator.
Children Ministry	Coordinators use /children/coordinator; secure check-in at /admin/children-checkin.
Men's & Women's Ministry (/admin/men, /admin/women)	Edit each ministry's content.
Theology School (/admin/theology-school)	Manage the theology-school programme.
Leadership Page (/admin/leadership-content)	Edit the public leadership content.
Department Coordinators (/admin/coordinators)	Assign who leads each department.

9.2 Learning tracks

Bible Study	A full sub-menu: Overview, Reading Plans, Daily Readings, Resources, Settings, Groups and Chat Moderation.
Career (/admin/career)	Career Modules, Create Module and Sessions.
Skills Development (/admin/skills)	All Courses and Create Course.
Leadership Training (/admin/leadership)	The leadership-training curriculum.
Alter Sound	Worship-audio library: Overview, Categories, Tracks and Settings.

9.3 Member Journey group

Welcome Flow (/admin/welcome-flow)	The automated welcome sequence for new people.
Discipleship Pathway (/admin/discipleship)	Design the steps a member moves through to grow.
Counselling (/admin/counselling)	Manage counselling appointment requests and scheduling.
Life Events (/admin/life-events)	Handle wedding, baptism, dedication and memorial requests.

10. Admin — Prayer, Evangelism & Outreach

Prayer	Sub-menu: Overview, Categories, Schedules, Requests, Stats and Settings — runs the prayer wall and prayer life.
Live Prayer Center (/admin/intercessors)	Connect incoming prayer requests to intercessors; search members to assign.
Evangelism Sign-Ups (/admin/evangelism-signups)	People who responded to evangelism campaigns.
Missionaries (/admin/missionaries)	The missionary network and support.
Church Locations (/admin/locations)	Campuses and locations by continent → country, shown on the public map.
Kingdom Outcomes (/admin/decisions)	Record salvation/other decisions; toggle any to appear on the public Testimony page.
Conversion CRM (/admin/conversion)	Follow up new believers through a conversion-care pipeline.
Pastoral Care (/admin/pastoral-care)	The pastoral-care CRM — track member care, visits and needs.
Small Groups (/admin/small-groups)	Create and manage small groups and membership.

11. Admin — Site Content & Page Copy

This is where the 'edit anything' promise lives. These tools change the words, images and structure of the public site without a developer.

Site Chrome (/admin/site-content)	Navigation menus, footer, the Apps grid, standalone pages and email templates — the 'chrome' around every page.
All Pages (/admin/pages)	A directory of editable standalone pages.
Page Copy (/admin/page-copy)	Hero and headline copy for the data-backed pages: Apps, Sanctuary, Marriage Prep, Download, Life Events and Fasting. Tabs switch between them.
Onboarding Page (/admin/onboarding-page)	The onboarding hero, chapters and call-to-action.
Volunteer Page (/admin/volunteer-page)	The public volunteer hero, department list and form.
Branding (/admin/branding)	Upload the church logo and favicon used site-wide.
Legal Pages (/admin/legal)	Privacy policy and terms of service.
Translations (/admin/translations)	Multi-language UI text for a multilingual congregation.

Marriage-Prep controls inside Page Copy

- **Course length (weeks)** — one number that updates every 'N weeks' mention on the public page, the couple's checklist and the printed certificate.
- **Curriculum section** heading and sub-heading.
- **Hero CTA** button label and link.
- **Video calls (Jitsi)** — enable/disable couple↔pastor video sessions, and an optional self-hosted Jitsi domain.

12. Admin — People, Governance & Communications

Users (/admin/users)	All accounts. Edit profiles, assign roles, and filter by country. This is where access is granted or revoked.
Moderators (/admin/moderators)	Appoint people who can moderate chat and community content.
Messages (/admin/chat)	The staff messaging centre.
Nominations (/admin/nominations)	Review leadership nominations.
Governance → Lead Coordinators (/admin/leads)	Top-level coordinators over departments.
Governance → Audit Log (/admin/audit-log)	A tamper-evident record of sensitive admin actions — who did what, when.
Two-Factor Auth (/admin/2fa)	Turn on 2FA for your own account.

Roles & access

Access is controlled by each account's role. Administrators can do everything; other roles (moderators, coordinators, mentors, volunteers) see only their area. Always grant the least access a person needs, and use the Audit Log to review sensitive changes.

Communications

- **Announcements** — site-wide notices.
- **Newsletter** — subscriber emails.
- **Social Auto-Poster** — scheduled social posts.
- **Welcome Flow** — automated new-member emails.
- Transactional emails (enrolment, giving receipts, completion certificates) send automatically and use editable templates in Site Chrome.

13. Admin — System, AI & Global Tools

AI Features (/admin/ai)	Configure the site's AI-powered helpers.
Live AI Translation	Real-time translation for online services (paired with the Caption Operator).
3D Virtual Tour	The immersive tour surfaced at /tour.
Smart Speaker / Voice (/voice)	Voice-assistant presence for the church.
Database Backups (/admin/backups)	Create and download database backups. Take one before any big change.
Backend Diagnostics (/admin/diagnostics)	Health checks if something looks wrong — useful when contacting support.
Admin Settings (/admin/settings)	Global switches, including where the floating live banner appears.
SEO Meta / Sitemap / RSS	Search-engine metadata, the sitemap and feeds are generated for you and tunable at /admin/seo-meta.

Note: Backups are your safety net. Before deleting large amounts of content or reconfiguring giving, create a backup at **/admin/backups** first.

14. Key Workflows (Step by Step)

14.1 Going live for a service

- 1 Open **/admin/live-stream**, paste the stream URL (e.g. your YouTube live link) and turn the stream ON.
- 2 The floating live banner appears across the public site and the **/live** page activates with video, live chat and worship co-experience.
- 3 During the service, an operator can run captions/translation at **/admin/live-captions** for online viewers.
- 4 When the service ends, turn the stream OFF. The recording can be carried into the sermon library automatically.

14.2 The Sunday-to-sermon workflow

- 1 After the service, go to **/admin/sunday-automation** and run the pipeline on the recording — it produces a transcript, notes, an email, a blog draft, social posts and chapter markers.
- 2 Review and edit each output — nothing publishes without your approval.
- 3 Publish the sermon; it appears in **/sermons** with video/audio, notes and any attached document, and flows into the podcast RSS feed.
- 4 Optionally let the email and social posts go out to members and channels.

14.3 Receiving and reconciling giving

- 1 Ensure at least one provider is live at **/admin/payments** (Paystack/Stripe/Flutterwave/PayPal/bank).
- 2 Donors give at **/giving** — one-time or, on Stripe/Paystack, monthly.
- 3 Every gift lands in **/admin/donations** with donor, amount, fund, status and cadence.
- 4 Use the fund breakdown and status filters to reconcile against your bank/provider dashboards.

14.4 Running Marriage Prep

The marriage-preparation course is a complete mini-platform: public enrolment, a private couple portal, a curriculum with resources and video, pastor sign-off, a verifiable certificate, and video calls.

Set up the curriculum

- 1 Open **/admin/marriage-prep** → **Curriculum**. Click 'New module' and fill in week number, title, scripture, summary, teaching body and homework; mark it Published.
- 2 In each week's **Resources** section, add a link, upload a PDF/Word/PowerPoint/Excel document (up to 25 MB), or add a YouTube/Vimeo video that embeds for couples. (For a brand-new week these are staged and saved with the module.)
- 3 Set the overall course length in **/admin/page-copy** → Marriage Prep → 'Course length (weeks)'. This number appears everywhere, including the certificate.

Enrol and run a couple

- 1 Couples enrol themselves at **/marriage-prep**; they receive a welcome email with their private portal link.
- 2 In **/admin/marriage-prep** → **Couples**, use **Portal link** to copy their link, **Edit** to fix details, and **Video call** to join their private video room (see 14.5).
- 3 Couples work through each week in their portal — reading teaching, opening resources, watching videos, writing shared reflections and marking weeks complete.
- 4 When they finish, click **Sign off** and enter your name as the pastoral signature (plus an optional private note).

The certificate

- The moment you sign off, the couple's **Certificate of Completion** appears in their portal, printable and saveable as PDF.
- Each certificate carries a QR code and a short fingerprint. Scanning the QR verifies it live at letw.org — a forged or altered certificate fails verification.
- The certificate reflects the admin-set course length automatically.

14.5 Video calls in Marriage Prep (Jitsi)

- 1 Ensure video calls are enabled in **/admin/page-copy** → Marriage Prep → 'Video calls (Jitsi)'.
- 2 Couple side: in their portal, the 'Meet your pastor by video' card → **Start video call** opens the meeting embedded on the page.
- 3 Pastor side: in **/admin/marriage-prep** → Couples, click **Video call** on that couple to join the same private room.
- 4 The room is unique to each couple, so only those with the link (the couple and the pastor) can join.

Note: On the free public Jitsi service, the first person in may briefly see a 'waiting'/pre-join screen — that is normal. For a fully branded, lobby-free experience, self-host Jitsi and set your domain in the Jitsi field.

14.6 Bookings, events and life events

- **Sanctuary / Hall Booking** (/admin/sanctuary) — manage rooms and approve booking requests for weddings and gatherings.
- **Events** (/admin/events) — create events, add photos, and (where enabled) manage RSVPs.
- **Life Events** (/admin/life-events) — process wedding, baptism, dedication and memorial requests submitted from /life-events.

14.7 Corporate fasting & prayer seasons

- **Fasting Calendar** (/admin/fasting) — schedule corporate fasts and daily prayer prompts shown on /fasting and /lent.
- **Prayer** — manage the prayer wall, categories, schedules and requests; route requests to intercessors via the Live Prayer Center.

15. Understanding the Content System

Most editable pages follow one consistent pattern, so once you learn one editor you can use them all.

- Each editable page is stored under a named key (for example the marriage-prep page copy).
- The admin editor loads that record, you change fields, and Save writes it back.
- The public page merges your saved content over sensible defaults — so a half-finished edit never blanks the page; any field you leave empty falls back to the built-in default.
- Item-level content (sermons, events, rooms, curriculum weeks, files) lives in its own dedicated admin, while the hero/headline copy for those pages is centralised in **Page Copy**.

Practical implications

- If a public page still shows old wording after editing, confirm you saved the right tab/key and refresh (caching can delay a few seconds).
- To change a number or phrase that appears in several places (like the course length), look for the single setting that drives them all rather than editing each page.
- Uploaded media and files are stored in the database; keep individual files under 25 MB and use external links for large video.

16. Security, Publishing & Hosting

16.1 Security practices

- Enable **2FA** for every administrator.
- Grant the least access each person needs; review the **Audit Log** regularly.
- Never share provider secret keys; store them only in **/admin/payments** and the providers' own dashboards.
- Take a **backup** before large or risky changes.

16.2 How changes reach the public site

Day-to-day content changes go live automatically when you Save — no technical step required. Deeper changes to the software itself are published by the technical team through the hosting platforms (Vercel for the website, Render for the application and database). If you have a developer, they push code to the project's repository and trigger a rebuild; you, as an administrator, do not need to do this for normal operations.

Note: *Hosting credentials, deploy keys and payment secret keys are sensitive. They are held by your technical administrator and in the hosting dashboards — not in this manual.*

17. Troubleshooting

A change I saved isn't showing	Confirm you saved the correct page/tab, then hard-refresh the public page. Content can take a few seconds to update due to caching.
The site is slow on the first visit	The application server may have been idle and is waking up. The first request can take up to a minute; afterwards it's fast.
Giving button says 'setup in progress'	No active payment provider is configured. Add and activate one at /admin/payments.
Monthly giving option is missing	Recurring shows only when a Stripe or Paystack provider is active. Configure one with valid keys.
A certificate won't scan / verify	Very old printed certificates can be denser and harder to scan; reprint the current version. If a couple was deleted, their certificate is intentionally revoked and will not verify.
Marriage-prep resources/video not visible	You must save a brand-new week first (staged items save with it). Confirm the week is Published.
Video call won't embed	Confirm video calls are enabled in Page Copy; use the 'Open in a new tab' fallback if a browser blocks the embed.
Something looks broken platform-wide	Check /admin/diagnostics, then contact your technical administrator with what it reports.

End of manual

This manual reflects the current live feature set of the LETW website. As new capabilities are added, update the relevant section so the manual stays complete.